Muhammad Usama Zafar (扎法馬)

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Professional Profile

Ph.D. Candidate in Information Management at National Chung Cheng University. Research interests include explainable AI, anomaly detection, information security, fintech, and applied machine learning.

Research Interests

- Explainable AI (XAI)
- Anomaly Detection
- Information Security
- Fintech
- Artificial Intelligence / Machine Learning

Education

2022–Present	**Ph.D. in Information Management** *National Chung Cheng University, Taiwan*
2020–2022	**M.S. in Control Science & Engineering** *Xi'an Jiaotong University, China*
2015–2019	**B.S. in Software Engineering** *Government College University, Faisalabad, Pakistan*

Publications

Journal Articles:

[1] Zafar, U., Wu, F. Methodological challenges in explainable AI for fraud detection: a systematic literature review. *Artificial Intelligence Review 59, 115* (2026). https://doi.org/10.1007/s10462-026-11516-7 (**Q1, SCI, IF-18.8**)

Conference Papers:

[1] Zafar, U., Wu, F., & Hsieh, Y. C. (2026). "Detecting AI-Inpainted Refund-Claim Images Using Explainable Cues and Deep Ensembles." 2026 14th International Conference on Information Management and Engineering (ICIME 2026), Yokohama, Japan. (Best Presentation Award)

[2] Zafar, U., Li, E.Y. (2024). Financial inclusion and fintech ecosystems in the digital age: A systematic review and meta-analysis. *ICEB 2024 Proceedings (Zhuhai, China)*. 50. https://aisel.aisnet.org/iceb2024/50

[3] Li, E. Y., Zafar, U. (2023). Fostering Fintech adoption in growing economies: Opportunities, challenges, and strategies. *ICEB 2023 Proceedings (Chiayi, Taiwan)*. 27. https://aisel.aisnet.org/iceb2023/27

[4] Shehwar, D. E., Gul, S., Zafar, U., Shaukat, U., Syed, A. H., & Zaidi, S. S. H. (2021). "Acoustic Wave Analysis in Deep Sea and Shallow Water Using Bellhop Tool." *2021 OES China Ocean Acoustics (COA)*. https://doi.org/10.1109/COA50123.2021.9519944

Languages

English	**Listening**	**Speaking**	**Reading**	**Writing**
	Advanced	Advanced	Advanced	Advanced
Mandarin	**Listening**	**Speaking**	**Reading**	**Writing**
	Basic	Basic	None	None

Academic Service

2023–2025	**EMI English Corner Tutor** *College of Management, National Chung Cheng University*
Spring 2026	**Teaching Assistant — Analysis and Application of Big Data** *Undergraduate course*
Spring 2026	**Teaching Assistant — Advanced Software Engineering** *Ph.D. course*
Fall 2025	**Teaching Assistant — Data Communications & Networks** *Graduate course*
Fall 2025	**Teaching Assistant — Object-oriented System Analysis and Design** *Graduate course*
Spring 2025	**Teaching Assistant — Analysis and Application of Big Data** *Undergraduate course*

Professional Experience

2017–2022	**Web Developer (Freelance)** Developed websites and digital content for e-commerce, blogs, and related web projects using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, SQL, PHP, and WordPress.

Technical Competencies

Python, Artificial Intelligence / Machine Learning, Explainable AI, Anomaly Detection, Software Engineering, Web Development, C/C++, Java / OOP, HTML / CSS / PHP, Computer Networking, Databases, Microsoft Office, WordPress

Awards

2025-2026	**Ph.D. Scholar** *Chung Hwa Rotary Educational Foundation Academic Scholarship*
2023-2024	**Overseas Research Scholarship** *National Chung Cheng University, Taiwan*
2021	**Excellent International Student** *Xi'an Jiaotong University, Xi'an, China*
2020-2022	**Chinese Government Scholarship** *Xi'an Jiaotong University, Xi'an, China*

References

Ph.D. Advisor	**Fan Wu,** *kfwu@mis.ccu.edu.tw* *Professor, National Chung Cheng University, Taiwan*
Dean of Academic Affairs	**Long-Chuan Lu,** *bmalcl@ccu.edu.tw* Professor, National Chung Cheng University, Taiwan
Master's Advisor	**Yuan-Li Cai,** *ylicai@mail.xjtu.edu.cn* *Professor, Xi'an Jiaotong University, China*